

032. Chapter 3 Verses 19-21

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.19

तस्मादसक्तः सततं कार्यं कर्म समाचर ।
असक्तो ह्याचरन्कर्म परमाप्नोति पूरुषः ॥ 19 ॥

tasmādasaktaḥ satataṁ
kāryaṁ karma samācara |
asakto hyācarankarma
paramāpnoti pūruṣaḥ ||

tasmāt – therefore; **asaktaḥ** – unattached; **satatam** – constantly;
kāryam – which ought to be done; **karma** – action; **samācara** – perform;
asaktaḥ – unattached; **hi** – indeed; **ācaran** – performing; **karma** – action;
param – the Supreme; **āpnoti** – attains; **pūruṣaḥ** – a man.

Therefore that work which should be done, do it well always without attachment. He who performs all the prescribed duties in a detached spirit will attain the Supreme.

VERSE 3.20

कर्मणैव हि संसिद्धिमास्थिता जनकादयः ।
लोकसंग्रहमेवापि सम्पश्यन्कर्तुमर्हसि ॥ 20 ॥

karmaṇaiva hi saṁsiddhim
āsthitā janakādayaḥ |
lokasaṅgrahamēvāpi
sampaśyankartumarhasi ||

karmaṇā – by action; **eva** – only; **hi** – indeed; **saṁsiddhim** – perfection;
āsthitāḥ – attained; **janaka-ādayaḥ** – Janaka and others;
loka-saṅgraham – welfare of the world; **eva** – only; **api** – also;
sampaśyan – having in view; **kartum** – to perform; **arhasi** – you should.

**King Janaka and others attained perfection by action. Even
having in view the need to show the right path to the masses,
you should work.**

VERSE 3.21

यद्यदाचरति श्रेष्ठस्तत्तदेवेतरो जनः ।
स यत्प्रमाणं कुरुते लोकस्तदनुवर्तते ॥ 21 ॥

yadyadācarati śreṣṭhas
tattadevetaro janah |
sa yatpramāṇam kurute
lokastadanuvartate ||

- ◆ **yat yat** – whatever; **ācarati** – does; **śreṣṭhah** – a great man;
- ◆ **tat tat** – that very thing; **eva** – only; **itarah** – other; **janah** – people;
- ◆ **saḥ** – he; **yat** – what; **pramāṇam** – standard/example; **kurute** – sets;
- ◆ **lokaḥ** – the world/people; **tat** – that; **anuvartate** – follows.

What-so-ever a great man does, that other men do; whatever he sets up as the standard, that the world follows.